The Disability Tax Credit, Explained

What it does for you even if you have never worked a day

Compiled 4 November 2026, revised 5 November 2026, for The Alberta Disability System Breakdown. Every figure is sourced at the end, with the page it came from and the date it was read.

The myth

Ask around any disability group in Alberta and you will hear this:

> "The Disability Tax Credit is for people who work. I'm on AISH. It does nothing for me."

Half of that is right. The half that is wrong is costing people thousands of dollars a year.

The right half. The Disability Tax Credit is a non-refundable tax credit. Non-refundable means it can bring the tax you owe down to zero, and then it stops. The Canada Revenue Agency says it plainly: "If the DTC total is more than the amount an individual owes on their taxes, the CRA will not refund the remaining amount of the credit." If you owe no tax, the credit by itself puts no money in your pocket. That part of the rumour is true.

The wrong half. The credit is not the point. **Approval is the point.** Being approved for the Disability Tax Credit is a key, and the key opens doors that have nothing to do with whether you work and nothing to do with whether you owe tax.

The biggest one: **$1,000 a year, every year, that you do not have to put a single dollar of your own money in to get, and that Alberta does not count as income or as an asset.**

Most people on AISH have never been told it exists.

READ THIS FIRST: the part Alberta takes back

Before anything else, so that nobody applies expecting something that will not arrive.

The Canada Disability Benefit is deducted off your AISH or ADAP cheque, dollar for dollar.

(One thing to watch while you are reading: Alberta's own "Apply for federal disability supports" page still says the benefit pays "up to $200 per month." That is last year's rate. If a worker quotes you $200, the federal page is the one to go by.)

The Canada Disability Benefit is the new federal payment, up to $204.20 a month from July 2026 to June 2027, and you need Disability Tax Credit approval to get it. It sounds like the answer to everything. In Alberta it mostly is not.

Here is why, word for word from the regulation. **AR 96/2026, Schedule 1, section 1(1)**, says a director must include the following when determining your income:

> "(e) a Canada disability benefit under the Canada Disability Benefit Act (Canada) that is
> (i) not paid for the purpose of offsetting a person's cost of applying for a disability tax credit under subsection 118.3(1) of the Income Tax Act (Canada), and
> (ii) not exempted by section 7(2)."

And **section 11(1)** of the same regulation says what happens to income once it is counted:

> "The following must be deducted from a living allowance benefit, modified living allowance benefit, child benefit or personal benefit provided under section 13 of Schedule 3: ... (b) the client's income as determined by a director in accordance with Schedule 1."

Put those two together. The Canada Disability Benefit counts as income. Income comes off your living allowance. **For a person on the ordinary AISH or ADAP living allowance, the net gain from the Canada Disability Benefit is zero.** You receive $204.20 from Ottawa and Alberta takes $204.20 off the cheque.

The two exceptions, and they matter

Exception one: the $150. Look again at subparagraph (i). A Canada Disability Benefit payment that **is** paid to offset the cost of applying for the Disability Tax Credit is **not** counted as income. Since 1 September 2026 there is exactly such a payment: a fixed $150 lump sum, paid automatically, no application needed, to help cover what it cost you to get your DTC. The first payments went out on 17 September 2026. By the plain words of section 1(1)(e)(i), **that $150 is not income and must not be deducted.** Keep the letter. Check your cheque.

Exception two: modified living allowance. Schedule 1, section 7(2) says:

> "A Canada disability benefit under the Canada Disability Benefit Act (Canada) is exempt, and a director must not include it, when determining income for the purposes of determining (a) whether a person is eligible to receive a modified living allowance benefit, and (b) the amount of any benefit a person who is eligible to receive a modified living allowance benefit is eligible to receive."

If you are on the **modified living allowance**, which is the rate for people living in a facility or similar setting, the Canada Disability Benefit is fully exempt. You keep all of it. That is a real and significant difference, and it is the one group for whom the Canada Disability Benefit is straightforwardly good news.

Apply anyway. This is not optional.

Do not read any of the above as a reason to skip the Canada Disability Benefit. **The AISH and ADAP rules require you to apply for it, and not applying costs you more than applying does.**

The policy manual, word for word:

> "Applicants, clients and their cohabiting partners are required to access all income and assets they are eligible to receive. This includes requesting Canada Pension Plan - Disability, Canada Disability

> Benefit, and OAS benefits or assigning payment of these benefits in an amount equivalent to the living allowance or modified living allowance to AISH or ADAP."

And again, under pension income: "AISH and ADAP applicants and clients must access and claim all income they are entitled to receive to enhance their financial independence."

Alberta has already enforced this. Clients who did not have a Canada Disability Benefit decision by 28 February 2026 had **$200 taken off their benefits starting in April 2026**. That is a penalty for not applying, and it is separate from the ordinary dollar-for-dollar deduction.

So the arithmetic is not "apply and gain nothing, or skip it and keep things as they are." It is: **apply and gain nothing but keep your cheque whole, or skip it and lose $200 anyway and put your eligibility at risk.** Refusing to claim income you are entitled to is a financial eligibility problem, and a decision to deny eligibility on income grounds is appealable to the Citizens' Appeal Panel.

Apply, and report the outcome to your worker. The clawback is the thing the campaign is fighting. Your application is not the place to make that fight.

Nothing below depends on the Canada Disability Benefit. Everything below pays whether Alberta claws that one back or not.

What the Disability Tax Credit really is

Three sentences, then we will slow down.

It is a line on your income tax return that lowers the tax you owe. If you owe no tax, it lowers nothing. But to get it you must be **approved** by the Canada Revenue Agency, and that approval is recorded on your file, and a long list of other programs check that file before they pay you.

Terms, in plain words

Non-refundable tax credit. A discount on tax you owe. If you owe $900 in tax and have a $1,500 credit, your tax goes to zero and the extra $600 disappears. It is not paid out.

Refundable tax credit. Real money. If you owe nothing, the government still sends it. The Canada Disability Benefit, the Child Disability Benefit and the GST credit work this way. The Disability Tax Credit does not.

Deduction. Lowers the income your tax is calculated on, rather than the tax itself. Worth nothing if you have no taxable income.

Approval, as opposed to the credit. You are approved for the DTC for a period of years, or indefinitely. The approval sits on your CRA file whether or not you ever use the credit. **The approval is the asset.**

The amounts

For the **2025 tax year**, from the CRA's own table:

Who	Federal disability amount
18 and older	$10,138
Under 18	$10,138 plus a $5,914 supplement, so $16,052

For the **2024 tax year**: $9,872, with a $5,758 supplement for a person under 18.

For the **2026 tax year** the disability amount is **$10,341**, from the Department of Finance's June 2026 report on non-refundable credits. The 2026 under-18 supplement was not published on the pages read.

What that is worth in cash, and the rate just changed. Federal non-refundable credits are multiplied by the lowest federal tax rate, and that rate was cut. The Department of Finance: "Bill C-4 reduced the lowest marginal personal income tax rate from 15 per cent to 14.5 per cent for the 2025 taxation year and to 14 per cent for the 2026 and subsequent taxation years." The 2025 rate is a blend because the cut landed halfway through the year. The CRA's own footnote: "The federal tax rate decreased from 15% to 14% on July 1, 2025, making the tax rate 14.5% for 2025."

So, our arithmetic, not the CRA's:

Tax year	Disability amount	Rate	Worth, off federal tax
2025	$10,138	14.5%	about **$1,470**
2025, under 18	$16,052	14.5%	about **$2,328**
2026	$10,341	14%	about **$1,448**

And it is worth exactly nothing to you if you owe no federal tax. Hold that thought until the section on transfers.

One footnote for anyone with higher income: a Top-Up Tax Credit, in place for 2025 to 2030, "effectively maintains the current 15 per cent rate for non-refundable tax credits claimed on amounts in excess of the first income tax bracket threshold." That threshold was $57,375 for 2025. It does not change anything for a reader on AISH.

Alberta has its own disability amount on top of the federal one, claimed on **form AB428 at line 58440**, with the transfer at **line 58480**. Alberta credits are multiplied by 10 percent. The current Alberta figure is one of the unconfirmed items listed at the end of this document, so no number is printed here.

Who qualifies

This is where most people count themselves out before they start, so read it slowly.

The CRA says: "You may be eligible for the DTC if a medical practitioner certifies that you have a severe and prolonged impairment in 1 of the categories, significant limitations in 2 or more categories, or receive therapy to support a vital function."

The categories

- Walking
- Mental functions
- Dressing
- Feeding
- Eliminating, meaning bowel or bladder functions
- Hearing
- Speaking
- Vision
- Life-sustaining therapy
- **Cumulative effect of significant limitations**, which means two or more of the above added together

What "markedly restricted" means

Word for word:

> "You are unable to do the activity, or it takes 3 times longer than someone of similar age without the impairment, even with the use of appropriate therapy, medication, and devices."
> "This restriction is present all or almost all of the time (generally at least 90%)."
> "The restriction has lasted or is expected to last for a continuous period of at least 12 months."

Three things to notice, because they are the three things people get wrong.

One. "Three times longer" is a real door. You do not have to be unable to do the thing. If dressing takes you three times as long as someone your age without your condition, that is a marked restriction in dressing.

Two. "Even with the use of appropriate therapy, medication, and devices" cuts both ways. If your medication works and you function fine on it, you may not qualify. If you still take three times as long even with the medication, the medication does not disqualify you.

Three. The cumulative category is the one people miss. You do not need to be markedly restricted in any single category. Two or more **significant** limitations that together add up to the same effect will do it. The CRA's wording: the limitations must "exist together all or almost all of the time (generally at least 90%)" and their combined effect must be "present all or substantially all of the time (generally interpreted as 90% or more), even with the use of appropriate therapy, devices, and medication." Life-sustaining therapy does not count toward the cumulative category.

Mental functions is a listed category in its own right. It is not a lesser category and it is not a last resort.

If you were turned down before 2025, apply again

An old refusal is not a current refusal. If you were denied the Disability Tax Credit before 2025, Alberta's own federal supports page says to reapply. Do not let a letter from 2019 decide this for you.

Life-sustaining therapy

The checklist on the CRA page says the therapy must be "needed at least **2 times** per week" and "needed for an average of at least **14 hours** per week, taking time away from everyday activities," for at least 12 months.

A caution. The same page's chemotherapy example refers to therapy "at least 3 times per week." The page does not reconcile the two, and it was last modified 24 January 2023 while the rest of the DTC pages were modified in October 2026. If your claim turns on the number of times per week, get it checked rather than relying on either number.

How to apply

Pick one method and stick to it. The CRA says: "Choose only one method to apply. Both Part A and Part B must be submitted using the same method."

The digital route, which is faster

1. **You do Part A.** Sign in to your CRA account, go to Benefits and credits, choose Apply for DTC. No CRA account? Phone **1-800-959-8281** and speak to an agent, or **1-800-463-4421** for the automated line.
2. **You get a reference number.** It is "valid for up to 12 months and can be used only once."
3. **Your medical practitioner does Part B** online with that reference number. **You cannot fill in Part B yourself.** There is no way around this and no point trying.

The paper route

Form **T2201**, version 23e or 23f. Part B must be signed by hand. Part A and Part B go in the same envelope to a tax centre at Jonquière, Sudbury or Winnipeg.

One warning from the CRA's own page: "you must send your DTC application to the CRA using the digital DTC application form or by mail. You may not send DTC forms through the 'submit documents' section of your CRA account." People lose months this way.

Who is allowed to sign

Practitioner	Can certify
Medical doctor	All impairments
Nurse practitioner	All impairments
Optometrist	Vision
Audiologist	Hearing
Occupational therapist	Walking, feeding, dressing
Physiotherapist	Walking
Psychologist	Mental functions
Speech-language pathologist	Speaking

Nurse practitioners can certify everything. If you cannot get in to see a doctor, that is the line to remember.

Eliminating, meaning bowel or bladder, is not listed for any practitioner other than a doctor or nurse practitioner.

The fee, and who pays it

The CRA: "If your medical practitioner charges a fee for completing the DTC application, you are responsible to pay it. However, you may be able to claim it as a medical expense on your tax return." That is lines 33099 or 33199.

But if you are on AISH or ADAP, do not stop there, because the program will cover that fee. Bring your worker an invoice or a written cost estimate from the practitioner. The program issues it as a supplemental benefit and you pay the practitioner. The catch: you are required to repay the program once the federal government reimburses you for the fee.

If the up-front cost is the thing stopping you from applying, say that to your worker in those words. That is exactly the situation the supplemental benefit is for.

The $150 federal supplement

The federal government has added a **$150 supplement** to the Canada Disability Benefit to help cover what a practitioner charges for the medical part of the form. You do not apply for it. A letter should arrive.

- The rule took legal effect on **1 September 2026**, and the first payments went out on **17 September 2026**, to people who received a Canada Disability Benefit payment at any point between July 2025 and June 2026.
- A second phase is due in **Winter 2027**, for people who became eligible from July 2026 onwards or who were approved for a new Disability Tax Credit certificate. No month has been named. If you see a specific date circulating, it is not from a government source.

It is **$150 for each approved Disability Tax Credit certificate** that qualifies you for the benefit, rather than one payment per person forever. It is not payable for anyone who died before September 2026.

And in Alberta it is not deducted. By section 1(1)(e)(i) of Schedule 1, money "not paid for the purpose of offsetting a person's cost of applying for a disability tax credit" is not income. That is precisely what the $150 is. Check your statement. If $150 shows up as income against you, ask in writing for a breakdown and point at **Schedule 1, section 1(1)(e)(i) of AR 96/2026**, quoted above. That is the provision that protects the $150. The pension income policy in the manual is the weaker pointer, because it may not mention the $150 at all.

MYTH-BUSTER ONE: the ten years behind you

> "you may be able to claim it going back up to **10 years**."

Read that again. Approval is not only forward-looking. If your condition has lasted for years, the CRA can reassess up to a decade of past returns.

The box. On the application form, Part A, there is a box asking the CRA to reassess your previous returns. The CRA says: "We will automatically reassess your previous tax returns if you checked the box asking us to do so in Part A of the DTC application form."

Tick the box. If you did not, you can still fix it: in your CRA account go to Tax returns, then Change my return, and pick each year; or mail a letter asking the CRA to adjust the returns.

Does this pay if you never owed tax? On its own, no. If you owed no tax in any of those ten years, reassessing them produces nothing. But two things change that.

First, the transfer, below. If a family member supported you in those years and owed tax, the back years can go to them.

Second, the other programs. Being found eligible back to, say, 2016 can matter for the Registered Disability Savings Plan carry-forward and for the Child Disability Benefit, both of which look at which years you were eligible. The money comes out of those, not out of the credit.

MYTH-BUSTER TWO: you can give it to someone who does owe tax

This is the one that proves the rumour wrong on its own terms.

The CRA: "Any unused amount may be transferred to a supporting family member. It is not refunded."

So if you owe no tax, the credit does not vanish into nothing. It can go to a family member who supports you.

Who counts as a supporting family member

- Your spouse or common-law partner

- Your child or grandchild
- Your parent, grandparent, brother, sister, uncle, aunt, niece or nephew
- Your spouse's or partner's child or grandchild
- Your spouse's or partner's parent, grandparent, brother, sister, uncle, aunt, niece or nephew

The condition

You must depend on that person "for at least 1 of the basic necessities of life (food, shelter, and clothing)."

One of the three. Not all three. If your sister buys your groceries, that is food. If you live in your parent's basement, that is shelter.

How it is done

Name them on the application form, Part A, question 2. If you did not name them at the time, the CRA says "they can submit a written request to the CRA for the transfer. This request must be signed and include details of the support they provide for the basic necessities of life."

The lines on the return: **31600** if you are claiming it for yourself, **31800** for a dependant other than a spouse, **32600** for a spouse or common-law partner.

Put the two myth-busters together. A person on AISH, approved back ten years, living with a parent who buys the groceries, can hand that parent ten years of unused disability amounts. At roughly $1,470 a year federally for 2025, before the Alberta portion, that is a serious number, and it lands in the household that has been carrying the cost.

MYTH-BUSTER THREE: $1,000 a year for putting in nothing

This is the big one. This is the thing almost nobody on AISH has been told.

The Canada Disability Savings Bond

A **Registered Disability Savings Plan**, or RDSP, is a savings account for a person approved for the Disability Tax Credit. Most people hear "savings plan" and stop listening, because they have nothing to save. Keep listening.

The government pays a **bond** of up to **$1,000 a year** into that account for low-income Canadians with disabilities. And here is the sentence that matters, word for word from the CRA:

> **"No contributions have to be made to get the bond."**

You do not put in a dollar. You open the account and the money arrives.

How much, by income. These are the 2026 figures, from Employment and Social Development Canada, which runs the grant and bond:

Family income	Bond
$38,237 or less	**$1,000 a year**
Between $38,237 and $58,523	Part of the $1,000, by a formula in the Canada Disability Savings Act
$58,523 or more	Nothing

Two details that catch people. The income used for your 2026 grant and bond is the income on your **2024** tax return, not this year's. And the cut-off is "greater than or equal to $58,523," so at exactly $58,523 the bond is nil.

A single person on AISH is nowhere near $38,237. **You get the full $1,000.**

The lifetime bond limit is $20,000.

And the ten years behind you, again

> "Before the end of the year you turn 49 years of age, you can carry forward up to 10 years of unused grant and bond entitlements to future years, as long as you met the eligibility requirements during the carry-forward years (for example, if you were approved for the disability tax credit and you were a Canadian resident)."

The catch-up is capped at **$11,000 of bond in a single year** and $10,500 of grant.

Work through what that means. A person approved for the Disability Tax Credit back to 2016, who opens an RDSP in 2026, can have up to ten years of unused bond entitlement waiting. That is up to $10,000 of bond, and up to $11,000 can land in one year. For putting in nothing.

This is why the ten-year retroactive box on the application matters even to someone who has never paid a cent of income tax.

What you must do to get it

- Be approved for the Disability Tax Credit
- Be a Canadian resident with a social insurance number
- Open the plan before the end of the year you turn 59, and note that **grant and bond stop at the end of the year you turn 49**
- **File your tax returns.** The CRA: "To qualify for the bond or to earn a grant, the beneficiary must file income tax and benefit returns for the past two years and all future taxation years when they have an RDSP."

File your return even with zero income. It is the single most common reason people on assistance lose money they were entitled to.

The grant, for anyone who can put something in

If you or anyone else can put money in, the **Canada Disability Savings Grant** matches it. With family income at or below **$117,045**, the 2026 figure:

- On the **first $500** you put in: **$3 for every $1**, up to $1,500 a year
- On the **next $1,000**: **$2 for every $1**, up to $2,000 a year

Maximum $3,500 of grant in a year, $70,000 over a lifetime. So $1,500 of your own money becomes $5,000 in the account. Anyone can contribute with the plan holder's permission, which is worth knowing if a relative has been looking for a way to help.

THE ALBERTA PART, and this is why it is the best door

Two provisions of AR 96/2026, both word for word.

It does not count as an asset. Schedule 2, section 2(2): "The following assets are exempt, and a director must not include them, when determining the value of assets: ... (d) a registered disability savings plan under section 146.4 of the Income Tax Act (Canada)."

The money coming out does not count as income. Schedule 1, section 7(1): "The following income reportable under the Income Tax Act (Canada) is exempt, and a director must not include it, when determining income: ... (g) a payment under a registered disability savings plan under section 146.4 of the Income Tax Act (Canada)."

Nothing else in the regulation is protected at both ends like this.

The AISH asset limit is **$100,000** under section 4(1)(c)(i). An RDSP sits outside that limit entirely. It can grow past $100,000 and it still does not count. And when the money eventually comes out, it is exempt income, so it is not deducted off your cheque.

So the Canada Disability Benefit gets clawed back and the RDSP bond does not. If you take one thing from this document, take that.

The catch, stated plainly

Money that goes in is meant to stay in. **For every $1 you take out, $3 of any grant or bond paid into the plan in the previous 10 years must be repaid**, up to the total of what was paid in over those ten years. The CRA's own example: withdraw $600, repay $1,800.

This is a long game. It is not an emergency fund. Withdrawals are meant to begin by the end of the year you turn 60, and that is when the holdback has aged out.

If you lose DTC approval later, since 2021 the plan holder can choose to close the plan or keep it open. Kept open, no new contributions, grants or bonds go in, but "the grants and bonds that were received by the plan are not required to be repaid solely due to the loss of the beneficiary's DTC approval." Withdrawals before age 60 still trigger the repayment rule. If you are approved again later, the plan goes back to normal.

MYTH-BUSTER FOUR: if you have a disabled child, this is cash

The Child Disability Benefit

For the benefit year **July 2026 to June 2027**, a family can get **up to $3,480 a year, which is $290.00 a month, for each child who is eligible for the Disability Tax Credit**.

It is paid on top of the Canada Child Benefit. It is a payment, not a credit, so it does not care whether you owe tax.

You do not have to apply. The CRA: "If you are already getting the CCB for your child who is eligible for the DTC, you do not need to apply for the CDB. You will get it automatically."

When a child is approved for the first time, "the CRA will automatically calculate your payments for the current and two previous benefit years." For anything earlier than that you must write to your tax centre and ask.

It starts to shrink once adjusted family net income passes **$82,847**: by 3.2 percent of the amount over that for one eligible child, and 5.7 percent for two or more.

The Alberta part

This one Alberta leaves alone, and here is the reasoning.

AISH counts income under Schedule 1, section 1(1)(a): "income reportable under the Income Tax Act (Canada) that is not exempted by or under section 7." The Child Disability Benefit and the Canada Child Benefit are **not reportable income** under the Income Tax Act. They are tax-free payments. So they are not caught by paragraph (a) at all.

Notice that the Canada Disability Benefit needed its own separate paragraph, (e), written into the regulation to be counted. That is the proof: if a tax-free federal payment were already caught, they would not have had to add one.

The reasoning above rests on the words of AR 96/2026. How the policy manual's income exemption table treats these payments in practice is listed at the end among the items still to be confirmed.

The doors that do need a job, or tax owing

Being straight about this is the whole point of the document. These exist, and for most people reading this they are worth nothing today. Know them anyway, because circumstances change.

Canada Workers Benefit, disability supplement

Refundable, so it pays even if you owe no tax. Up to **$843** for the 2025 tax year. **But the calculation runs on earned working income.** No work income, nothing to calculate. It shrinks once adjusted net income passes $37,740 single or $49,389 family, and disappears above $43,360 single.

If you work even part time, this is real money and it is refundable. If you do not work, it is not for you.

Home accessibility tax credit, line 31285

Non-refundable. Up to **$20,000** of eligible renovation expenses a year, for a person eligible for the Disability Tax Credit at any time in the year, or aged 65 or over. A spouse, parent, child or supporter can claim it for you.

Non-refundable means it only reduces tax owing. If the renovation is being paid for by a working family member, it is theirs to claim.

Disability supports deduction, line 21500

A deduction, not a credit, so it only lowers taxable income. It covers what you paid for supports in order to work, go to school, or do research under a grant. Worth nothing without taxable income. Form T929.

Note that the CRA page for this one requires "an impairment in physical or mental functions" and does not name the Disability Tax Credit as a condition.

The housing doors

Home Buyers' Plan

Not a credit at all. It lets you take up to **$60,000** out of an RRSP to buy a home, repaid over 15 years, with no tax withheld.

The part that matters here: the **first-time buyer rule is waived**. The CRA: "you must be considered a first-time home buyer. If your participation is in respect of a specified disabled person, this condition does not have to be met." That covers buying or building a home for a disabled person, or helping them buy or build one, where the home "must enable the specified disabled person to live in a more accessible dwelling."

Whether "specified disabled person" means exactly the same thing as Disability Tax Credit eligibility is listed at the end among the items still to be confirmed.

A related point: for the **home buyers' amount at line 31270**, a person eligible for the Disability Tax Credit also does not have to be a first-time buyer.

Multigenerational home renovation tax credit, line 45355

Refundable. 14.5 percent of up to $50,000 of qualifying costs, to a maximum of **$7,250 per claim**, for building a self-contained secondary suite so that "a senior or an adult who is eligible for the disability tax credit" can live with a qualifying relative.

Refundable means it pays out even with no tax owing. If a family is building a suite so an adult child can move in, this is the one to look at.

What the Disability Tax Credit is not

Clearing out the other rumours while we are here.

It is not AISH, and AISH does not require it. They are separate systems with separate medical forms and separate decision makers. Being on AISH does not approve you for the DTC. Being approved for the DTC does not get you onto AISH.

It is not CPP Disability. Also separate, also its own application.

Being approved does not cost you anything you already have. The CRA: "being eligible for other federal or provincial disability programs does not affect eligibility for the DTC." And nothing in AR 96/2026 makes DTC approval a reason to reduce or refuse AISH or ADAP.

It is not permanent in every case. Approval can be for a set number of years. Watch for the expiry and re-apply before it lapses, because the RDSP grant and bond, the Child Disability Benefit and the Canada Disability Benefit all stop with it.

It is not a judgement about how disabled you are. It is a tax rule with a 90 percent test and a three-times-longer test. Plenty of people who are clearly disabled get refused on the wording, and plenty get approved on a second try with a better-completed Part B.

The order to do things in

Not advice, just the order that gets the money flowing soonest.

1. **File your tax returns.** Every year, even with zero income. Nothing below works without this, and the RDSP bond needs the last two years filed.
2. **Apply for the Disability Tax Credit.** Digital if you can. **Tick the box in Part A asking the CRA to reassess your previous returns.**
3. **Name a supporting family member in Part A question 2** if there is someone who supports you with food, shelter or clothing, so unused amounts can go to them.
4. **Once approved, open an RDSP.** Any bank or credit union that offers them. Ask specifically about the **bond** and say you may not be contributing. The bond does not require contributions.
5. **Ask the RDSP issuer about carry-forward** for every year you were DTC-eligible.
6. **If you have a child approved for the DTC and you already get the Canada Child Benefit**, the Child Disability Benefit should start on its own. Check that it does.
7. **Apply for the Canada Disability Benefit too, and tell your worker the outcome.** AISH and ADAP require you to claim income you are entitled to. Not applying does not protect your cheque: people without a decision by 28 February 2026 had $200 taken off from April 2026.
8. **Watch for the $150** supplemental payment, and check your statement to be sure it was not deducted.
9. **If you were refused the DTC before 2025, apply again.** Alberta's federal supports page says to.

What we could not confirm

Tagged the way the campaign tags everything.

Item	Status
The 2026 under-18 supplement	**NOT FOUND.** The 2026 disability amount of $10,341 was found in the Department of Finance report; the supplement was not. The CRA table still showed 2025 as its latest when read on 4 November 2026.
The child care and attendant care reduction that claws back the under-18 supplement	**NOT FOUND** on the pages read. It exists; the threshold was not published on the claiming page.
The current Alberta disability amount	**TO VERIFY.** The CRA Alberta page shows $15,284 in text dated 2022 under a 2025 breadcrumb.
Life-sustaining therapy: 2 times or 3 times per week	**CONFLICTING.** The checklist says 2, an example on the same page says 3. The page was last modified 24 January 2023.
Canada Disability Benefit income thresholds for July 2026 to June 2027	**NOT CONFIRMED.** The page's examples and formulas still use the 2025-26 figures of $23,000 and $32,500 while quoting the new $204.20 maximum.
Whether "specified disabled person" for the Home Buyers' Plan equals DTC eligibility	**TO VERIFY.**
Whether the AISH policy manual treats the Canada Child Benefit and Child Disability Benefit as exempt	**TO VERIFY** against the manual's income exemption table.
Whether the $200 non-application reduction still applies after February 2026, or was a one-time enforcement	**TO VERIFY** against the current Alberta page. The campaign's source is the government's "Apply for federal disability supports" page.
When the DTC eligibility criteria were last broadened	**NOT CONFIRMED.** Alberta's page tells people refused before 2025 to reapply, and that instruction is sourced. The reason is not. A broadening in the 2021 federal budget, covering mental functions and the life-sustaining therapy frequency, is the one we can point to, and the CRA's own life-sustaining therapy page carries a leftover "3 times per week" example beside a "2 times" checklist that fits a change of that kind. No 2025 change has been confirmed. The guide therefore gives the instruction without a reason.

Sources

Source	Date modified	Read
CRA, Disability tax credit overview, canada.ca .../disability-tax-credit.html	22 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, About the DTC, .../disability-tax-credit/about-dtc.html	22 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Claiming the DTC, .../disability-tax-credit/claiming-dtc.html	22 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Who is eligible, .../disability-tax-credit/eligible-dtc.html	22 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, How to apply, .../disability-tax-credit/how-apply-dtc.html	22 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Life-sustaining therapy, .../eligible-dtc/life-sustaining-therapy.html	24 Jan 2023	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Tax credits and deductions for persons with disabilities	20 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
Canada.ca, Canada Disability Benefit, landing page	19 Oct 2026	4 Nov 2026
Canada.ca, Canada Disability Benefit, eligibility.html	15 Sep 2026	4 Nov 2026
Canada.ca, Canada Disability Benefit, amount.html	15 Sep 2026	4 Nov 2026
Canada.ca, Canada Disability Benefit, apply.html	15 Sep 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, RDSP overview	23 Dec 2025	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Canada Disability Savings Grant and Bond	16 Sep 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Opening an RDSP	23 Dec 2025	4 Nov 2026
CRA, RDSP payments and rules	23 Dec 2025	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Cessation of disability or death of a beneficiary	28 Nov 2024	4 Nov 2026

Source	Date modified	Read
CRA, Child disability benefit	15 Jun 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Canada workers benefit, how much you can get	8 Apr 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Line 31285 home accessibility expenses	24 Jul 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Line 21500 disability supports deduction	20 Jan 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Home Buyers' Plan, overview and participation	17 Feb 2026 and 20 Jan 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Line 45355 multigenerational home renovation tax credit	20 Jan 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Information for residents of Alberta, 5009-PC	20 Jan 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Federal tax rates, current and previous years	25 Jun 2026	4 Nov 2026
CRA, Current year tax rates and income brackets, 2026	25 Jun 2026	5 Nov 2026
Employment and Social Development Canada, How much you could get in grants and bonds	10 Jul 2026	5 Nov 2026
AISH and ADAP Policy Manual, financial eligibility and pension income sections, campaign baseline of 30 August 2026	Held in the research library	5 Nov 2026
Government of Alberta, Apply for federal disability supports (the $200 reduction, the pre-2025 reapplication rule, and the supplemental benefit for the practitioner's fee)	Cited in the ADSB FAQ, checked August 2026	5 Nov 2026
Department of Finance Canada, Report on the Impact of Reducing the Lowest Marginal Personal Income Tax Rate on Non-Refundable Tax Credits, June 2026	June 2026	4 Nov 2026
AR 96/2026, Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped General Regulation, King's Printer office consolidation, current as of 1 October 2026, consolidated to AR 244/2026	Held in the research library	4 Nov 2026

The AISH regulation sections quoted: section 4(1)(c) asset limits, section 11(1) deduction from benefits, Schedule 1 section 1(1)(a) and (e), Schedule 1 section 7(1)(g), Schedule 1 section 7(2), Schedule 2 section 2(2)(d).

This is information, not advice. We are not accountants and we are not your caseworker. Rules change, and the figures above carry the dates they were checked. Verify anything you are about to rely on, and keep every letter you are sent.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown. Speak up. Speak out. Be heard.